Gonia · measured ancient architecture · saved comparison

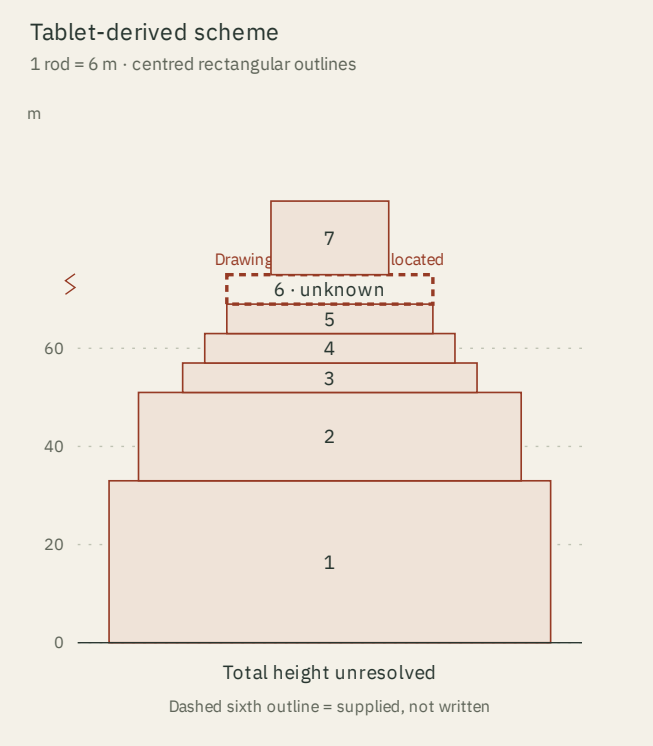
A tower between two sources.

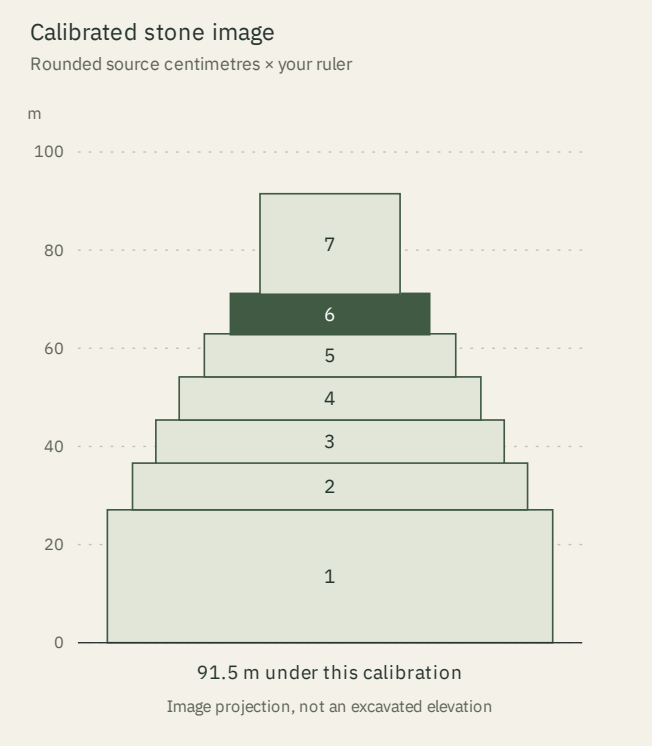
Babylon's Etemenanki: a later clay-tablet copy and a carved stone image preserve different evidence. This reading keeps the supplied dimensions visible.

Your two projections

The sixth-storey measurements are unresolved. Written-height subtotal in the conventional reading: 84 m. There is no total tower height from that subtotal alone.

Your image ruler assigns 91.5 m to 12.5 cm overall image width. The scale factor is 7.32 m per image centimetre. Applying it to all rounded height measurements gives 91.5 m. That is an inference from a chosen scale.





Both diagrams use equal horizontal and vertical metres. Rectangular outlines and centred terraces are this lesson's comparison convention. The unknown-gap diagram's top sanctuary is not vertically located. Sloping walls, stairs, courtyards and building phases are not reconstructed.

Every row keeps its source. Metres are rounded for display; the CSV keeps the computed numeric values.

Level	Tablet-derived L × B × H (m)	Status	Image W × H (cm)	Projected W × H (m)
1	90 × 90 × 33	Conventional reading	12.4 × 3.7	90.77 × 27.08
2	78 × 78 × 18	Conventional reading	11 × 1.3	80.52 × 9.52
3	60 × 60 × 6	Conventional reading	9.7 × 1.2	71 × 8.78
4	51 × 51 × 6	Conventional reading	8.4 × 1.2	61.49 × 8.78
5	42 × 42 × 6	Conventional reading	7 × 1.2	51.24 × 8.78
6	Unknown	No written row	5.5 × 1.1	40.26 × 8.05
7 · sanctuary	24 × 22.5 × 15	Conventional reading	3.9 × 2.8	28.55 × 20.5

Save the numerical CSV · Save the editable comparison record

Sixth is supplied; seventh is written.

The numerical sequence in the retained 1914 edition runs from the fifth storey to the seventh-storey sanctuary. The conventional sixth storey, 5½ by 5½ rods and one rod high, completes a 90 m scheme. Removing that row leaves 84 m of known heights, not an 84 m tower. Changing its dimensions explores a hypothesis; it does not restore a lost measurement.

The sanctuary's breadth is 3¾ rods in the modern interpretation used here. At 6 m per rod its footprint is 24 × 22.5 m. Scheil's earlier reading of the fractional expression is retained on the full page and differs from this interpretation. The retained BTTo transliteration also displays 2½ for the lower height while its translation reads 5½; this activity uses the retained 1914 row's 5½ and labels the scheme conventional.

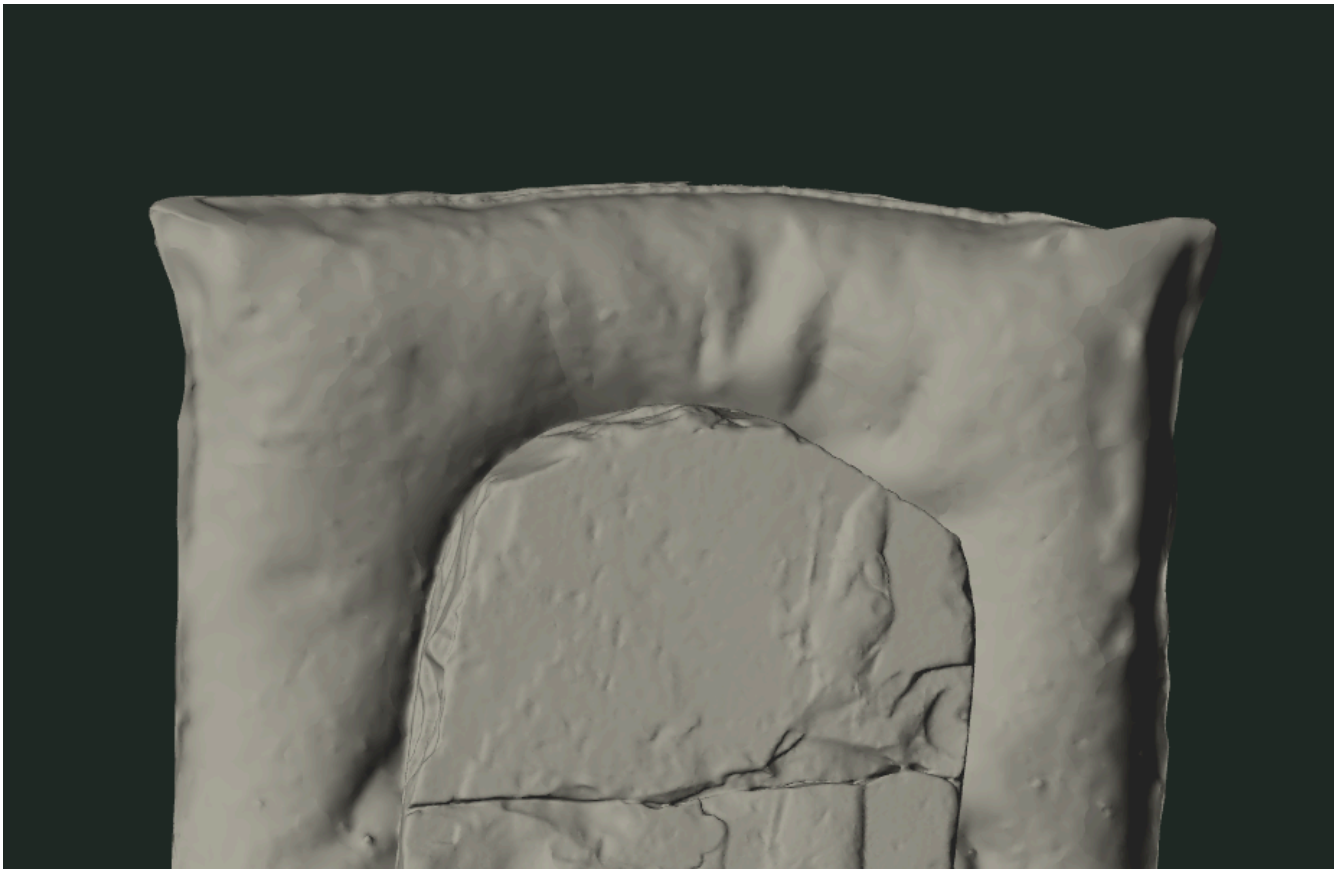
The missing-row controls hold the other conventional dimensions fixed. Montero Fenollós, with Vegas and Mileto, p. 204, discusses a 66 m proposal that reinterprets other rows too. Changing only the sixth row cannot reproduce every published hypothesis.

One stone can use more than one scale.

Pedersén reports the plan of the top sanctuary at approximately 1.8 times the elevation's scale. Treating both as a single uniformly scaled drawing would make the plan too large. The royal figure and the building also do not establish a common human scale.

The source's rounded image heights total 12.5 cm. The paper also describes 12.5–12.8 cm overall height and alternative ground levels. This comparison projects those figures under the ruler you selected; it does not replace them with a falsely exact measurement of the ancient tower.

Your inspection of the source scan



Photogrammetry: Olof Pedersén, October 2023, Zenodo 10374395, CC BY 4.0. New rendering: turn 0°, tip 0°, light -35°, zoom 5, plain geometry. Geometry is a scan of the stone and its support, not a scan of the ancient tower. All 189,027 original triangles retained; new averaged normals and illustrative lighting. The texture retains its photographed lighting. The live viewer is not embedded in this script-free document.

Read the numerical language

Capital forms identify signs. Lowercase forms identify Akkadian words. These normalized reading aids do not reproduce every wedge, restoration or early editorial reading.

Lower brickwork

15 GAR ÚS · 15 GAR SAG · 5½ GAR SUKUD

Length 15 rods; breadth 15 rods; height 5½ rods: the lower brickwork.

Numerical reading aid from Scheil's p. 300, with normalized sign labels. At the chosen 6 m conversion: 90 × 90 × 33 m. The retained BTTo transliteration displays 2½ here while its translation reads 5½; this activity explicitly follows the 5½ in the retained 1914 numerical row and the conventional scheme.

Second storey

13 GAR ÚS · 13 GAR SAG · 3 GAR SUKUD · rik-bi 2-ú

Length 13 rods; breadth 13 rods; height 3 rods: the second storey.

A normalized numerical aid, not a diplomatic transcription. The photograph's second terrace is much shallower when the stone's image is projected with one uniform scale.

Third storey

10 GAR ÚS · 10 GAR SAG · 1 GAR SUKUD · U_5 3-šú

Length 10 rods; breadth 10 rods; height 1 rod: the third storey.

A normalized aid to the numerical row. At 6 m per rod this is 60 × 60 × 6 m. The 6 m height belongs to this conventional reading; it is not a new measurement of a surviving terrace.

Fourth storey

8½ GAR ÚS · 8½ GAR SAG · 1 GAR SUKUD · U_5 4-ú

Length 8½ rods; breadth 8½ rods; height 1 rod: the fourth storey.

The half rod changes the footprint to 51 × 51 m under this conversion. The row gives dimensions, while the centred position in the comparison drawing remains a modern convention.

Fifth, then seventh

7 GAR ÚS · 7 GAR SAG · 1 GAR SUKUD · U_5 5-šú … U_5 7-ú

The fifth storey is given dimensions. The next surviving row names the seventh. There is no written sixth-storey dimension row in between.

The ellipsis is this lesson's omission marker. Modern editors supply a sixth row. Use the missing-level controls to distinguish a supplied value from a written one.

Top sanctuary

4 GAR ÚS · 3¾ GAR SAG · 2½ GAR SUKUD

Length 4 rods; breadth 3¾ rods; height 2½ rods: the upper sanctuary.

The breadth follows the modern 3¾ interpretation. Scheil's 1914 page reads the fractional expression differently. At 6 m per rod, the scheme is 24 × 22.5 × 15 m; it is not a 24 m square.

Copied and checked

GABA.RI bar-sip.KI … SAR-ma … ù ba-ri

A duplicate from Borsippa … written … and checked.

Selected words only, with omissions explicitly marked. The colophon describes transmission of a text. A checked copy can still contain a missing row and is not an excavator's field measurement.

ÚS · šiddu

length. A sign label in capitals, followed by the Akkadian word. Scheil writes uš; the modern corpus lemmatizes the word as šiddu. Do not pronounce the capital sign label as an Akkadian sentence.

SAG · pūtu

breadth. Literally also 'front' or 'forehead'. In these measurements it names the breadth. A second horizontal dimension does not tell us where the next terrace sits.

SUKUD · mēlû

height. Scheil uses gud in his older transliteration. The modern sign label SUKUD is associated with Akkadian mēlû. The units still have to be identified before converting to metres.

GAR / NINDA · nindanu

a measuring rod; a length unit. The numerical comparison uses the conventional conversion 1 nindanu = 12 ordinary cubits ≈ 6 m. The tablet also discusses other cubit standards: a single automatic conversion is not valid for its entire text.

KÙŠ · ammatu

cubit. A length unit, not one universal modern length. The 90 m tablet-derived scheme and a 91.5 m excavated base are kept separate rather than silently equated.

---

rik-bi / U_5 · rikbu

storey. The second storey is written with a syllabic word; later rows use a sign. The label seventh after fifth is evidence for a gap, not surviving measurements for the gap.

KI.TA · šaplû

lower. The lower brickwork in the first numerical row. It does not by itself tell us the construction date, material strengths or present surviving height.

upper. The upper sanctum belongs above the terraces. Its 4 by 3¾ nindanu footprint is rectangular; the drawing below shows a front elevation, not a square plan.

Keep the sources distinct

These are two ways of reasoning from surviving evidence, not measured elevations of the ancient building. The tablet is a later copy; a missing line is supplied by editors. The stone image is worn, and treating its proportions as a uniform scale is an assumption. Neither source fixes every wall, stair, terrace offset or construction phase.

The clay tablet AO 6555 was copied at Uruk in Seleucid year 83 (229 BCE), from a Borsippa exemplar according to its colophon. It is later than Nebuchadnezzar II's building. Louvre object record; current digital edition.

The stone's provenance is not a controlled modern excavation. Pedersén 2024 reports a 1990s find based on villagers' accounts without photographic corroboration and a return to Iraq in December 2023. Authenticity has been debated; George 2024 argues that it is genuine. Neither this rendering nor a source's authority independently settles those questions.

Save the complete retained 2024 article (PDF). Olof Pedersén, *The Tower of Babylon Stele Found in Babylon*, IRAQ 85, 179–191, DOI 10.1017/irq.2024.4, CC BY 4.0. The image measurements and plan-scale comparison come from pp. 188–189. The article's provisional drawing distinguishes insecure reconstructions in grey.

The complete retained source images

§ 7.

28. *2-ta ê (meš) ša im-si-sa ša (an) É-a u (an) Nusku ê (an) É-a 1.25 uš*
29. *30 sag ê (an) Nusku 35 uš 35 sag ê ša im-gal-lu ê (an) A-nim u (an) Én-zu*
30. *1.10 uš 30 sag ê ša im-mar-tu Tu-'-um u ê nam-mil-ti*
31. *ina ku-tal-li-šu pa-ni kâ a-nu-u ê (giš) nâ 2.5 uš 30 sag*
32. *pa-ni ê a-nu-u 1.40 uš 20 sag ê nam-mil-ti ki-i pi-i-šu-nu-ma uš*
33. *35 sag dul 1.40 uš 1.5 sag dul ṣu-ul-[li] u (giš) sak-kul-me la-ma*
34. *[(giš)] nâ 9 U uš 4 U sag (giš) nâ u (giš)[gu]-za tar-ṣu (giš) nâ 2 ta*
35. *[u] dul na-ša-a-ti kâ (an) Babbar-ê kâ im-gal-lu kâ (an) Babbar šú kâ im-si-sa*
36. *šal-ša-a-ti uš sag u gud (diš-ši) ti nu-ḫar Tin-tir-ki* *mu-nê*

REVERS.

§ 8.

1.	*15 gar uš*	*15 gar sag*	*5 1/2 gar gud*	*im-rù-a*	*šaplu-û*
2.	*13 gar uš*	*13 gar sag*	*3 gar gud*	*sim-bi*	*2-u*
3.	*10 gar uš*	*10 gar sag*	*1 gar gud*	*'u*	*3-u*
4.	*8 1/2 gar uš*	*8 1/2 gar sag*	*1 gar gud*	*'u*	*4-u*
5.	*7 gar uš*	*7 gar sag*	*1 gar gud*	*'u*	*5-u*
6.	*4 gar uš*	*3 1/2 gar igi-gaz sag*	*2 1/2 gar gud*	*dar (?)an-ta*	*7-u ša-ḫu-ru*

§ 9.

7. *zu-a-zu-a kan-kal-lim nu-zu-u nu ši an pi duppi gab-ri Bar-sip-ki*
8. *sar-ma* *ub-ṭu* *u* *ba-ri*

§ 10.

9. *18 mu-sar 1 gar 3 qa u 20 šam gar-gar ≈ 50 mu-sar (u-pu) 1 1/2 (gur) 3 qa*
10. *(i-di?) 1 gan 30 qa ≈ 6 (ip-lu) gan 3 pi*
11. *3 (bu-ru) 10 bur 1 gur 4 pi ≈ 60 × 10 bur (ša-a-ri) 60 bur 100 + 8 gur*

Scheil 1914, p. 300 · numerical rows. Whole printed page. Rows 1–5 are followed by row 6 naming the seventh storey; the sixth storey's measurements are absent. Scheil's older sign readings differ from the modern reading aids. Original source.

§ 7.

28. Par deux : maisons du Nord, celles d'Êa et de Nusku ; celle d'Êa, 1 . 25 de long,
29. 30 de large : celle de Nusku, 35 de long, 35 de large. Maison du Sud, celle d'Anu et Sin,
30. 1 . 10 de long, 30 de large. Maison de l'Ouest : le Tu'um et la maison du Filet.
31. Sur son arrière, face à la Porte des Ustensiles, la maison du Lit, 2 . 5 de long, 30 de large;
32. en face, la maison des Ustensiles, 1 . 40 de long, 20 de large; la maison du Filet, longue selon l'intervalle (des deux précédents)
33. et 35 de large. Une cour : 1 . 40 de long, 1 . 5 de large; cour couverte et entourée de barrières.
34. Le lit : 9 coudées de long et 4 coudées de large ; le lit et le trône auquel s'ajustait le lit : deux (pièces)
35. (et) une cour qui porte la Porte du Levant, la Porte du Sud, la Porte du Couchant, la Porte du Nord.
36. Le tiers, longueur, largeur et hauteur; base (?) de la Tour de Babylone, voilà leurs dénominations.

REVERS.

§ 8.

1. 15 *gar* de long, 15 *gar* de large, 5 1/2 *gar* de haut, en brique nature : étage inférieur.
2. 13 *gar* de long, 13 *gar* de large, 3 *gar* de haut, en briques brillantes (?) : deuxième étage.
3. 10 *gar* de haut, 10 *gar* de large, 1 *gar* de haut, en . . . : troisième étage.
4. 8 1/2 *gar* de long, 8 1/2 *gar* de large, 1 *gar* de haut, en . . . : quatrième étage.
5. 7 *gar* de long, 7 *gar* de large, 1 *gar* de haut, en . . . : cinquième étage.
6. 4 *gar* de long, 3 1/2 *gar* moins une fraction de large; 2 1/2 *gar* de haut, bigarré jusqu'en haut : septième étage ou maison *šaḫuru*.

---

§ 9.

7. Registres des limites (?), superficies. . . selon une tablette-copie de Borsippa
8. écrit . . . et vérifié.

Scheil 1914, p. 304 · French translation. Whole printed page, including the unfilled jump from fifth to seventh storey. This early translation is retained as evidence, not as a current critical edition. Original source.

§ 10.

9. 18 jardins à 1 *gar* 3 *qa* ± 20 prairies à 2 *gar* (?) ± 50 jardins à [3 *qa* l'*upu* 1 1/2 *gar* (?).
10. 60 . . . *idi*, par 1 *gan* 30 *qa* ± 6 *ipla* (36 *gan*) à 3 *pi* l'*ipla*
11. 3 *ipla* (= 1 *buru*) et 10 *bur* à 1 *gur* 4 *pi* le *bur* ± 60 fois 10 *bur* à 108 *gur* le *šâru* (ou 60 *bur*)

---

12. Tablette d'Anu bêlšunu, fils d'Anu balaṭsu iqbî, fils de Siš-[illegible]-utu, citoyen d'Uruk
13. par Anu belšunu, fils de Nidintum Anim, fils de Sin maḫir unnini. A Uruk; mois de Kislimmu 26e jour
14. Année 83 de Séleucus, roi (12 décembre 229 av. J.-C.).

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15. (*Sur la marge* :) Par la volonté d'Anu et Antum qu'(elle) reste en bon état!

NOTES.

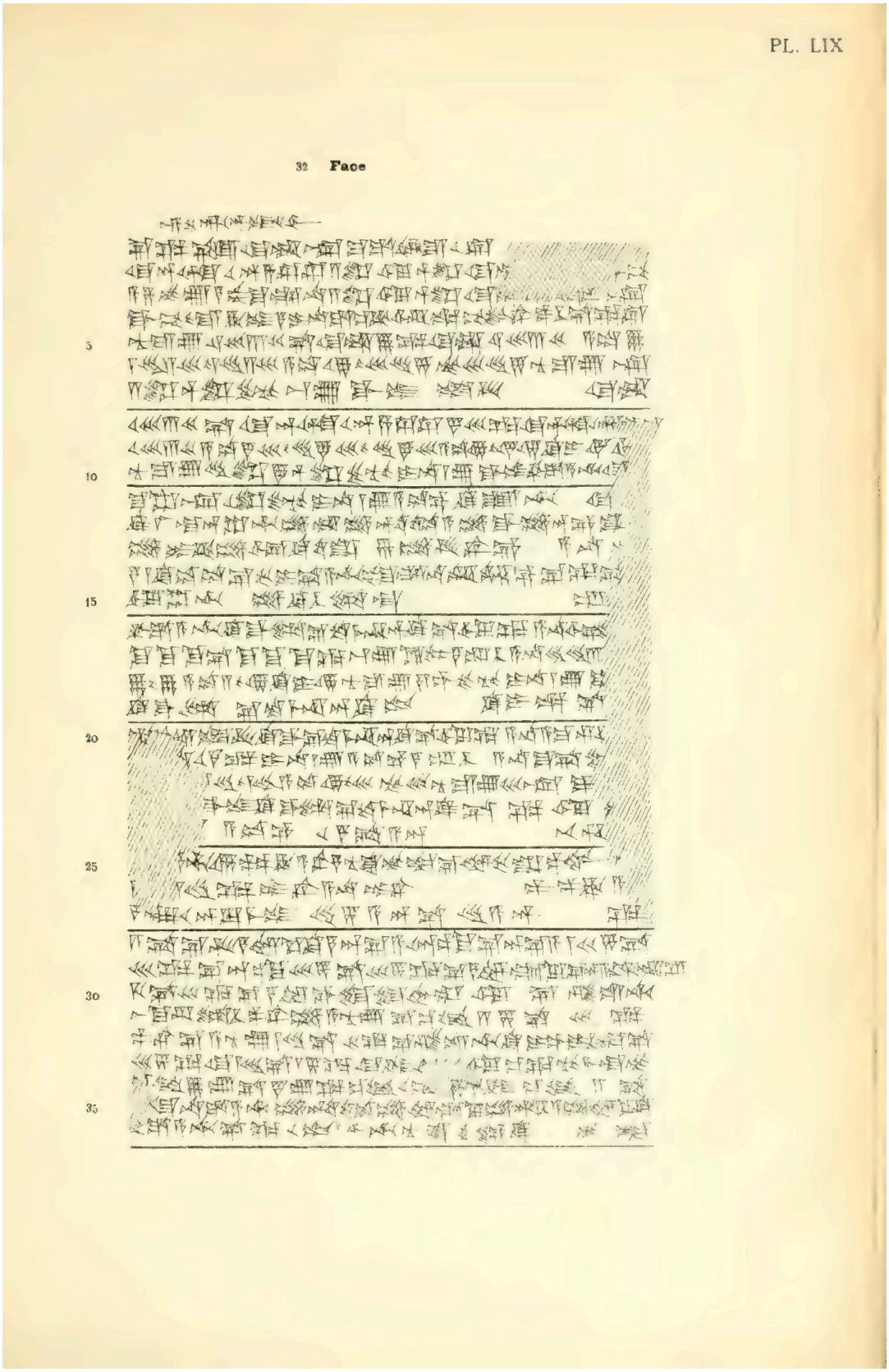
FACE.

3. *Azamû* ou *aṣamâ*.
   Dal tu[*r*] : le deuxième signe ne paraît pas douteux.
4. *Suḫatum* rac. *saḫû* « amonceler en détruisant », d'où peut-être pour le sens du substantif « terre-plein »; cf. *karâmu* et *karmu* (idéogr. UB).
   Dalat arkabinni synonyme de *daltum la qatitum* (II Rawl., 23, 63, 72 e. f. et 1-23 c. d.).
5. *Nuzû* « surface calculée en unités d'emblavure *gan* ou *šar* (*še numun*) », c'est le sens qui résulte de tous les passages où le mot est employé. Cf. *nuzzû* idéogramme  (Brunn. 1730) et (Brunn. 1884) où les dimensions de longueur et largeur seraient indiquées picturalement par le signe .
   A-du resp. *a-ra* : terme indiquant la multiplication.
6. MU = *aššu* (Brunn. 1226) correspond à *ki*, *infra*, lignes 9 et 18.
11. *Kimirti* rac. *kamâru* « étendre par terre », sens douteux.
12. *Kâ Lama-ra*. . . correspond à la porte *bâb* (*ilu*) *Lamassi a-ra-bi* de Nerigl., col. 1, 23 et suiv. (Cyl. Cambridge). Le second idéogramme correspond au n° 6225 de Brunnow.
14. KID-KID, avec la forme que ce signe affecte à l'époque séleucide où il a aussi la valeur *tad*, dans *ittad-din* par exemple.
15. Nabuchodonosor nomme 4 portes, aux flancs d'Etemenanki (*itât Etemenanki*) : *kâ Nunazu*, *kâ Lamma*, *kâ Nun ḫegal*, *kâ ûdi* (*bâb tabrâti*). (Langd. Nabuch. n° 17, col. 4, 10 et suiv.)
    Neriglissor Langd. n° 1, col. 1, 21 et suiv. : *babâni Esagila*, portes de l'Esagil : *kâ Ṣit samši*, *kâ Lamassi arabi*, *kâ ḫegalli*, *kâ ûdi*, identiques aux précédentes.

IMPRIMERIE NATIONALE.

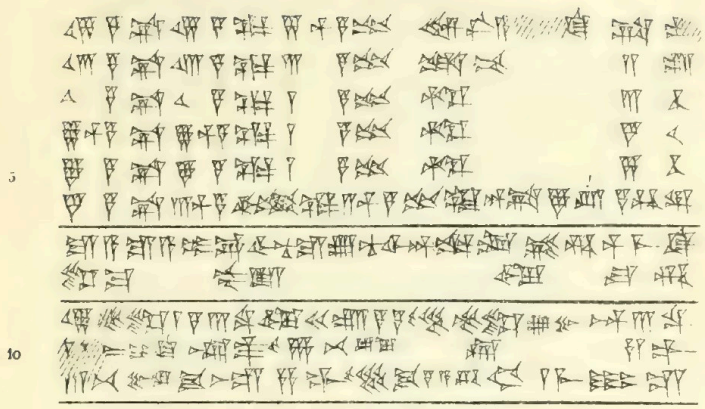
Scheil 1914, p. 305 · copy and date. Whole printed page. The colophon identifies Uruk, 26 Kislīmu, year 83 of Seleucus. Scheil converts it to 229 BCE; no day-exact modern conversion is needed here. Original source.

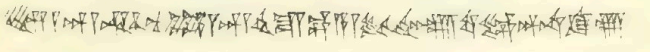
32 **Face**

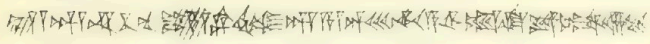


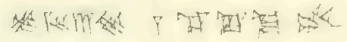
Thureau-Dangin 1922, plate LIX · obverse. Hand copy of AO 6555, no. 32, face. An editor's drawing of cuneiform signs, not a photograph of the clay. Original source.

32 Revers





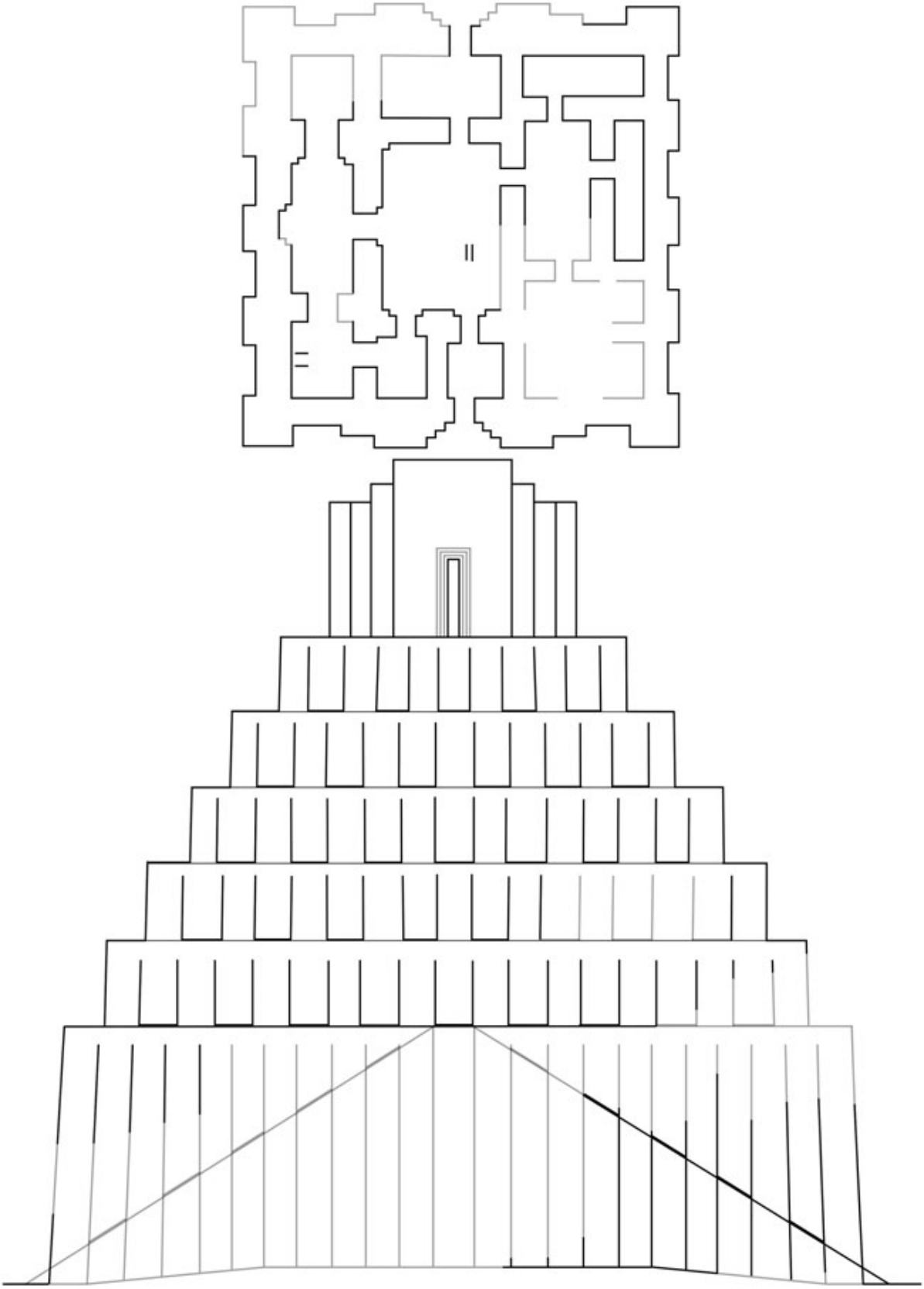




Thureau-Dangin 1922, plate LX · reverse. Hand copy of AO 6555, no. 32, reverse. The first rows continue the tower dimensions. Inspect the missing ordinal against the numerical table. Original source.



Pedersén 2024, figure 1 · stone photograph. Two joined fragments. The elevation and top-building plan occupy the upper part; the king is shown at a larger scale. Photograph Olof Pedersén, 2023, CC BY 4.0. Extracted unmodified from the article PDF. Original source.



Pedersén 2024, figure 3 · provisional drawing. A modern interpretation of the stone. Grey lines are insecure reconstructions. The plan above and elevation below do not share one scale. Drawing Olof Pedersén, 2023, CC BY 4.0; extracted unmodified from the article PDF. Original source.

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Scheil 1914 and Thureau-Dangin 1922: public-domain printed pages, via Persée and Internet Archive. Museum photographs are not bundled. Stele photograph, provisional drawing, article, scan and texture: Olof Pedersén, CC BY 4.0. The atlas texture was reduced to 2048 pixels; scan positions converted to float32 with no shape edits or simplification. New normals, lighting and numerical diagrams are identified as modern.

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